

Telegram Daily Tool Poster

Feature 1 & 2 of 13 — automated daily posts to your Telegram channel with click-tracked buttons.

No server required

Free (GitHub Actions)

Click tracking included

1 What this does

A script picks one tool from your catalog every day — deterministically, so it rotates through your whole list before repeating — and posts it to your Telegram channel with a "Visit" button. That button routes through your site's `/go/[slug]` link, the same click-tracked redirect the website itself uses, so Telegram clicks show up alongside website clicks.

It runs automatically, once a day, on GitHub's own servers — you don't need to keep a computer or server running.

2 Create your Telegram bot

STEP 1

Message BotFather

Open Telegram, search for `@BotFather`, and start a chat. Send the command `/newbot`.

STEP 2

Name it & get a token

Follow the prompts (pick a display name and a unique username ending in "bot"). BotFather replies with a token that looks like

`123456789:AAExxxxxxxxxxxxxxxxxxxxxxxxxxxxxxxxxxxxx`.

Copy it.

STEP 3

Add it to your channel

Open your Telegram channel → Administrators → Add Admin → search for your bot's username → give it permission to post messages.

Finding your channel ID

If your channel has a public username, it's simply `@yourchannelname`. If it's private, forward any message from the channel to `@userinfobot` to get its numeric ID (looks like `-1001234567890`).

3 Connect it to your site's code

In your GitHub repository:

1. Go to **Settings** → **Secrets and variables** → **Actions**
2. Click **New repository secret**, name it `TELEGRAM_BOT_TOKEN`, paste your bot token
3. Repeat for `TELEGRAM_CHANNEL_ID`, using your channel's @username or numeric ID

That's it — it's now live.

The workflow file `.github/workflows/telegram-daily-post.yml` already runs `scripts/telegram-post.mjs` every day at 15:00 UTC. Edit the `cron` line in that file to change the time.

4 Test it before going live

Preview exactly what will be posted today, with no bot token needed and nothing actually sent:

```
node scripts/telegram-post.mjs --dry-run
```

Once your secrets are set, you can also trigger a real post immediately (don't wait for the daily schedule) from GitHub: **Actions** tab → "Telegram daily tool post" → **Run workflow**.

5 Where the code lives

File	Purpose
<code>scripts/telegram-post.mjs</code>	Picks today's tool and posts it
<code>.github/workflows/telegram-daily-post.yml</code>	Free daily scheduler (GitHub Actions)
<code>data/products.json</code>	The tool list it picks from — same file the website uses
<code>app/go/[slug]/route.ts</code>	The click-tracked redirect the button links to

6 Troubleshooting

Problem	Fix
Nothing posted, workflow shows red x	Check both secrets are spelled exactly right, and the bot is an <i>admin</i> of the channel (not just a member)
"chat not found" error	Your channel ID is wrong — re-check the @userinfo bot trick above
Post looks wrong / cut off	Edit the <code>text</code> template inside <code>scripts/telegram-post.mjs</code>
Want a different time	Edit the <code>cron</code> line in the workflow file — cron times are UTC